

KITCHEN EXTRACT CLEANING

What the guidance says, and how often to clean

1. WHAT GOVERNMENT AND FIRE SERVICE GUIDANCE SAYS

- The government guide for small non-domestic premises (current, updated 20 January 2025; for small premises with simple layouts and low fire risk) says: “Suitable measures should be taken to prevent fires as a result of cooking or re-heating food.” and “Any filters or ducts, over cooking appliances, should be cleaned on a regular basis”.
- The Home Office guide **Fire safety risk assessment: small and medium places of assembly**, written for places such as pubs, clubs and halls, lists “cooking equipment, hot ducting, flues and filters” as sources of ignition. It names “allowing extraction equipment in catering environments to build up excessive grease deposits” as a common cause of equipment fires.
- London Fire Brigade says: “Kitchen ducting should be cleaned regularly to avoid a build-up of grease.” Its guidance note GN86 refers operators to TR/19® Grease and sets **annual cleaning as the minimum** for catering kitchen extract systems, unless the fire risk assessment recommends otherwise.

The government guides leave the frequency to your fire risk assessment. The scale below is where the usual figures come from.

2. HOW OFTEN? THE TR/19® GREASE USAGE SCALE

TR/19® Grease, published by the Building Engineering Services Association (BESA), sets minimum cleaning intervals by how many hours a day the kitchen cooks.

Level of use	Hours cooking per day	Clean the extract system every
Heavy	12 to 16 hours	3 months
Moderate	6 to 12 hours	6 months
Light	2 to 6 hours	12 months

- Grease between cleans must not exceed a **mean of 200 microns (0.2 mm)**, about half the thickness of a business card, measured with a wet film thickness gauge. Ask your contractor for readings before and after each clean.
- Fat frying, wood or charcoal cooking may need cleaning more often. Check your buildings insurer’s requirements too.

WORK OUT YOUR LEVEL

Hours the kitchen cooks each day: _____ Level: ☐ Heavy ☐ Moderate ☐ Light

Date of last extract clean: _____ Certificate seen: ☐ Yes ☐ No

3. SOURCES: SCAN OR CLICK TO READ THE ORIGINALS



HM Government
(GOV.UK)
[Making your small non-domestic premises safe from fire](#)



Home Office (GOV.UK)
[Small and medium places of assembly guide](#)



London Fire Brigade
[Takeaways, cafés and restaurants](#)



London Fire Brigade
GN86
[Catering kitchen extract systems \(PDF\)](#)



BESA
[Kitchen extract cleaning and TR/19® Grease](#)

Information checked on 10 October 2026. Guidance and web links can change, so check the originals for the latest version. Also used: Norfolk Fire and Rescue Service, Kitchen extraction systems. The TR/19® Grease scale and 200 micron limit are as published on BESA's website; check the TR/19® Grease guide itself for full detail. General information only; it does not replace a fire risk assessment of your premises.